

# HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN TURKMENISTAN

## *Complete Community Opposition How-To*

### INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Community action shapes what happens to the air, water, and deserts of Turkmenistan — but here the honest starting point is unlike any other in this series, because Turkmenistan is one of the most closed and tightly controlled states on earth, where independent organising inside the country is nearly impossible and genuinely dangerous, and where the real work of opposing environmental harm must be done largely from outside, on behalf of a silenced people and a harmed world. Turkmenistan sits on some of the planet's largest natural-gas reserves, and its aging, leaking gas infrastructure has made it one of the worst methane super-emitters in the world. Turkmenistan sits atop some of the planet's largest natural-gas reserves, and its aging, poorly-maintained, and leaking gas infrastructure has made it one of the very worst methane super-emitters in the entire world — its fields, flare stacks, and pipelines venting into the sky a climate super-pollutant that satellites now measure from space, in quantities that rival the emissions of entire industrial nations. It is also a land of environmental strain in other ways: a desert country drawing down shared rivers for cotton, a shrinking sea on its border, a burning gas crater in its sands. It is also a land of environmental strain in other ways: a desert country drawing down shared rivers to irrigate its cotton, a shrinking inland sea on its northern border, and a burning gas crater set deep in its sands. But its people cannot speak: there is no independent press, no opposition, no civil society, and those who criticise the state face prison or worse. But its people cannot speak of any of it: there is no independent press, no political opposition, no civil society, and those who dare to criticise the state face prison or worse. This guide will be honest — more honest here than anywhere — that inside Turkmenistan there is almost no space to organise, that there is no community victory to point to, that the state has not even joined the world's basic pledge to cut methane, and that the levers are almost entirely external; but it will show that those external levers, running through the satellites that cannot be blinded, the world's climate diplomacy, the buyers of the gas, and the diaspora, are real. Running through the satellites that cannot be blinded by any secrecy, the world's climate diplomacy, the buyers of the gas, and the exile diaspora, are real and can genuinely be used.

The Turkmen story teaches two things about opposing destructive projects here, and this guide states both plainly. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever pressed together. The second is distinctly Turkmen, and it is what gives this guide its real — if hard — force. **Because Turkmenistan's methane leaks are a globally significant climate harm that satellites reveal regardless of the state's secrecy, because the wasted gas has buyers and partners who can be pressed, because the world has pledged to cut methane and has diplomatic and economic reasons to act, and because a diaspora carries the truth the state suppresses, the levers reach the country from outside even though it is sealed from within: the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora.** That combination — the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora — is the distinctive lever here, and this guide is built around it, because a harm that can be seen from space and sold to the world can be pressed through space and through the world because a harm that can be seen from space and sold to the world can, in the end, be

pressed through the space that sees it and the world that buys it, even when the state that causes it cannot be reached at home.

But the same story carries honest qualifications this guide states plainly and takes with the utmost seriousness. **Inside Turkmenistan there is almost no room to act, the state depends on gas, its main buyer applies little pressure, and speaking out is dangerous.** This is among the most repressive states on earth; there is no independent civil society to build, no free press to persuade, no court to petition, and dissent is met with severe punishment; the state's revenue is gas, so it is bound to the industry that leaks; its largest customer cares little for the climate; and for anyone inside the country, open opposition is not merely difficult but perilous. This guide does not pretend a community can organise openly inside Turkmenistan, or that the state can be easily moved, or that there is any safety in domestic dissent. What it shows is how, from outside and through the world, the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora can be used to press one of the world's most consequential and most hidden environmental harms — carefully, and with the safety of any person inside the country placed absolutely first.

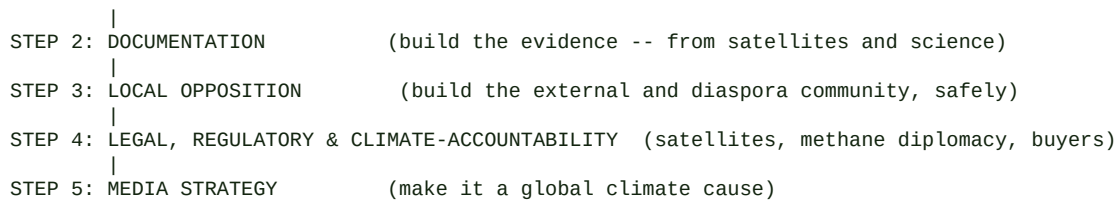
Most people who care about Turkmenistan's environment do not know HOW to use the levers that reach a closed state from outside. They see the satellite maps of the methane plumes, the reports of the leaking fields, the shrinking sea — and either despair at the country's closure or imagine that only inside pressure, which is impossible, could matter, and rarely grasp the external levers: the satellites that expose the harm, the world's methane pledges, the buyers of the gas, the diaspora that carries the truth. The gap between the harm exposed and the harm ignored is here often a gap of method — the method of using the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora together, from outside, and of protecting absolutely anyone inside.

**This guide shows what can actually be tried — inside the Turkmen reality as it is, which is one of the most closed states on earth, whose gas leaks harm the whole world.** It is written for the person — very often in the diaspora, or in the international community — who sees the methane plumes and the sealed country behind them, and who wants to know what can be done about a harm that is global but a state that is unreachable. The answer is a hard but real yes: the levers are external but genuine — the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora — with the honest qualifiers that inside the country there is almost no space, the state depends on gas and its buyer cares little, dissent is dangerous, and there is no victory to promise, only real external levers and the careful work of pressing a hidden harm through the world that can see it. A note on who this guide is for, and on the spirit in which it should be used, because this case differs from all the others. It is for the person outside Turkmenistan — in the diaspora, in the international climate community, in journalism, in science, in diplomacy — who wants to press a grave and hidden harm on behalf of a people who cannot press it themselves. It is emphatically not a call for anyone inside the country to act, organise, or speak, because to do so would be to court imprisonment or worse; anyone inside who reads this should understand that the guide's clearest counsel to them is to stay safe, and that the work it describes is to be done by others, from outside, on their behalf. This is an unusual and sober thing to say, but honesty requires it: in the most closed of states, the most important act of solidarity is often to shield those inside from all risk while carrying their cause abroad. This guide is an honest map of that external path — the path of pressing a global harm through the world that can see it, so that a silenced people need take no risk at all, and so that the burden of the effort falls entirely on those beyond the state's reach.

## The Strategic Framework

Effective efforts follow the same underlying pattern, adapted to a closed state where the work is external:

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION (find the harm, the source, and the exposure)



These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**, and almost entirely from outside. The satellite evidence feeds the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the world at once; the diaspora and international community organise, safely; a satellite report, a diplomatic approach, or a buyer appeal is both pressure and a spur to the next. The effort that runs all five together, from outside and protecting everyone inside, gives itself the best — if still difficult — chance of pressing this hidden, global harm.

## The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Turkmenistan's — a satellite-visible methane harm, a gas trade, a world pledged to cut methane, and a diaspora — give a distinctive, external set:

- **The satellite evidence.** The **methane leaks are visible from space**, so the harm cannot be hidden by the state's secrecy — a distinctive, foundational lever.
- **The methane diplomacy.** The **world's pledges and bodies to cut methane** give diplomatic and institutional pressure a closed state still feels.
- **The gas buyers and partners.** The **buyers and partners of the gas** can be pressed to demand lower-methane production — a lever on the trade.
- **The economic-waste argument.** The **leaked gas is wasted money**, so cutting the leaks can pay for itself — a lever even a climate-indifferent state can hear.
- **The diaspora.** The **exile media and diaspora** carry the truth the state suppresses and connect the harm to the world.

## What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers prevail, or that anyone can organise safely inside. There is **no landmark win** — the state has not even joined the world's methane pledge; inside the country there is **almost no space**; the state **depends on gas**; its main buyer applies **little pressure**; and dissent is **dangerous**. This guide takes those limits with the utmost seriousness — it states them plainly, and it puts the safety of anyone inside absolutely first — and shows how to use the real, external tools this situation offers — the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora — to press this hidden, global harm, honestly acknowledging the closure, the danger, and the absence of any victory.

## HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see — and here you must above all see that the levers are external, and that inside the country the danger is extreme. Before anything else, map who and what drive the harm, where the leverage is real, and — most importantly — how to act without endangering a single person inside. And map where the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora apply, because in Turkmenistan a destructive harm cannot be met by domestic organising, which is nearly impossible and dangerous, but only by using the world's ability to see, pledge, buy, and speak — from outside.

## The Levels of Decision — Mostly Outside

A Turkmen harm runs through levels that are, unusually, mostly beyond the country, because inside it there is little to reach.

**The state and its gas companies.** The **state and its gas companies** cause and control the harm, and are sealed and unaccountable at home — reachable, if at all, only through the external pressures they cannot fully ignore.

**The satellites and science.** The **satellites and scientific bodies** that measure the methane from space are the foundation, because they expose the harm regardless of the state's secrecy.

**The world's methane diplomacy.** The **international pledges, bodies, and governments** working to cut methane apply a diplomatic and institutional pressure a closed state still registers.

**The gas buyers and partners.** The **buyers and partners of the gas** — the states and companies that purchase or develop it — are a lever on the trade that funds the harm.

**The diaspora and international public.** The **exile media, diaspora, and international public** carry the truth and connect the harm to the world's conscience — standing in, of necessity, for a silenced domestic community.

## The Journey of a Harm

A Turkmen harm — a venting flare stack, a leaking pipeline, a super-emitting field — pours methane into the sky, measured by satellites, tied to the state's gas companies, and connected to the world through the buyers and the climate, with the **satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora** able to press it. **The satellite evidence is the foundation, and the methane diplomacy and the buyers are where the state is reachable** — and using them together, from outside, is the distinctive Turkmen approach. The distinctive levers are the **satellite evidence**, the **methane diplomacy**, the **gas buyers**, and the **diaspora**. Find out exactly where the harm is, and, crucially, **what it emits and where, which satellites and bodies have measured it, and how the methane diplomacy, the buyers, and the diaspora can press it**, because those are where a harm can genuinely be met — from outside.

## Follow the Gas, the Plume, and the Money

Behind a harm stand the state, its gas companies, and the buyers of the gas. Trace who causes it, who profits, who buys, and — importantly here — **what is emitted and where, how the satellites and science have exposed it, which buyers and partners are tied to it, and how the methane diplomacy and the diaspora can press it**. Two questions unlock most Turkmen efforts: **What is the harm, and who globally can see and reach it?** and **Which external lever — the satellites, the diplomacy, the buyers, the diaspora — can press it?** The satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, and the gas buyers are, together, the heart of most such efforts here — all from outside. Everything else in a Turkmen effort ultimately serves these: the documentation exists to establish the satellite-proven harm; the external community exists to carry it safely to the world; and the media exists to raise the climate and reputational stakes before the diplomats, the buyers, and the global public. Keep the satellite evidence, the world's methane diplomacy, and the gas buyers at the centre of every approach and appeal, and the effort retains a clear spine that runs from a plume seen from orbit to the world's climate institutions and the buyers of the gas, and that reaches a sealed state entirely from outside, endangering no one within it.

## The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that shape a harm, because they are the levers — and nearly all are external. The **state and its gas companies**; the **satellites and scientific bodies**; the **international**

**methane pledges, bodies, and governments; the gas buyers and partners; the exile media and diaspora; and the international public and climate community.** In Turkmenistan, the **satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the gas buyers, and the diaspora** are the distinctive levers, and all reach the country from outside. Each is a separate front, and a harm shown by satellite to pour methane into the world's sky, tied to the state's companies and the gas trade, can genuinely be pressed — through the world's climate diplomacy, the buyers, and the diaspora — though, honestly, inside the country there is almost no space, the state depends on gas, and dissent is dangerous, and this guide will keep saying so, and keep placing the safety of anyone inside absolutely first.

## QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit effort — and before anyone considers any risk inside — calibrate honestly, and here that means acknowledging that Turkmenistan is among the most closed states on earth, that the domestic space is essentially nil, and that the state depends on gas, even as the satellite evidence and the world's methane concern give real external leverage. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how external pressure on closed petro-states and methane super-emitters tends to work, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the harm can be **documented from satellites and science**, whether it can be **pressed through the methane diplomacy and the buyers**, and whether the whole effort can be **conducted safely from outside**. Where the harm is satellite-proven and the external ties are clear, the levers here are real; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that inside there is almost no space, the state depends on gas, its buyer cares little, and dissent is dangerous.

### Individual Step Success Rates

| Approach                       | Success Rate | Timeline     | Cost         | What "Success" Means                  |
|--------------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>Documentation only</b>      | 15–25%       | weeks        | low          | Basis for every other step            |
| <b>Satellite-evidence case</b> | 45–65%       | weeks–months | low          | The harm proven, undeniable           |
| <b>Methane diplomacy</b>       | 25–45%       | months–years | low          | Pledges, pressure, some movement      |
| <b>Gas-buyer pressure</b>      | 25–45%       | months–years | low–moderate | A buyer or partner demands better     |
| <b>Economic-waste argument</b> | 30–50%       | months–years | low          | Leaks framed as loss; a way in        |
| <b>Diaspora &amp; media</b>    | 40–60%       | months       | low          | The truth carried; the world informed |
| <b>International bodies</b>    | 30–50%       | months       | low          | Scrutiny, monitoring, a voice         |
| <b>All levers together</b>     | 30–50%       | months–years | moderate     | Pressure built; some emissions cut    |

**Key insight:** every step together beats any single one, and Turkmenistan's real strengths are external: the **satellite evidence**, the **diaspora and media**, the **methane diplomacy**, and the **gas buyers**. Its constraints are severe and honest: inside there is **almost no space**, the state **depends on gas**, its buyer applies **little pressure**, and dissent is **dangerous** — so progress comes through the satellites, the world's diplomacy, the buyers, and the diaspora, never through domestic organising.

## Effectiveness Visualization

|                          | External leverage (Diplo-macy) | Internal leverage (Economic) |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Satellite-evidence case: | ████████████████████           | 45-65%                       |
| Diaspora & media:        | ██████████████████             | 40-60%                       |
| Economic-waste argument: | ██████████                     | 30-50%                       |
| International bodies:    | ██████████                     | 30-50%                       |
| Single external lever:   | ████                           | 15-65%                       |

Any domestic organising: ■ near-impossible, unsafe  
External pressure / methane: ■■■■■■■■■■ slow but real  
Emissions cut / leaks fixed: ■■■■■■■■■■ achievable in part  
The harm exposed / recorded: ■■■■■■■■■■ the most reliable result

### Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The satellite evidence and the diaspora** — Turkmenistan's distinctive strengths; the harm made undeniable and carried to the world.
2. **The methane diplomacy** — the world's pledges and bodies, pressing a closed state.
3. **The gas buyers and the economic-waste argument** — the trade and the money, the ways in.
4. **The international bodies** — the scrutiny, monitoring, and voice.
5. **The satellite-and-science case** — the proven harm that grounds it all.



## What These Campaigns Actually Show

A few honest patterns recur. **The satellites are decisive** — a closed state cannot hide a methane plume from space, and that visibility is the whole foundation. **The diaspora carries the truth** — the exile media reveal what the state suppresses. **The economic argument is the way in** — leaked gas is lost money, which even a climate-indifferent state can hear. **The diplomacy is slow** — the state has not even joined the world's methane pledge. **Inside there is no space** — domestic organising is near-impossible and unsafe. The through-line: **document the harm from satellites and science; press the methane diplomacy, the buyers, and the economic-waste argument; carry it through the diaspora and the world; and never endanger anyone inside** — because an effort that does can genuinely expose the harm and build real methane pressure, while being honest that inside there is almost no space, the state is hard to move, and there is no landmark victory.

## STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective effort begins by finding the exact harm and its source — and the external leverage, since domestic leverage barely exists. Vague concern goes nowhere, and domestic confrontation is impossible and unsafe; an effort aimed at "this super-emitting field or venting flare stack, measured by these satellites, run by the state gas company, tied to these buyers, which the methane diplomacy and the diaspora can press" is a real, workable effort — the kind Turkmenistan's external levers can deliver. Answer five questions.

### The Five Core Questions

- 1. What is the harm, and what does it emit?** This is the first question here. What **methane, pollution, or environmental damage** does the source produce — the venting flare, the leaking field, the emissions — and how much.
- 2. How is it seen from space?** Which **satellites and scientific bodies** have measured or could measure it, since the exposure is the foundation of every external lever.
- 3. Which state companies and buyers are tied to it?** Which **state gas companies** run it and which **buyers and partners** are connected — the handles on the trade.
- 4. Which external lever applies?** How the **methane diplomacy, the buyers, the economic-waste argument, and the diaspora** can press it — the reachable pressure.
- 5. How is everyone inside kept safe?** Above all, how the effort proceeds **entirely from outside**, endangering no one inside — the absolute condition.

### A Worked Example

Suppose a super-emitting field is venting vast quantities of methane, measured by satellites, run by the state gas company, its gas sold abroad.

Working the five questions: **what does it emit? How is it seen from space? Which companies and buyers? Which external lever?** And how is everyone inside kept safe? The source and controller are the state and its gas companies, with the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the buyers, and the diaspora as the levers — all external.

Within a season the effort has moved from "the country is closed and nothing can be done" to a real external effort: document the emissions from satellite and science; press the methane diplomacy and the

economic-waste argument; approach the buyers and partners; and carry the truth through the diaspora — all from outside, endangering no one inside. That is a workable effort suited to Turkmenistan — one that reaches a sealed state through the world that can see it. Notice what the five questions accomplish, and how they suit a fight against a sealed state: they transform what looks like an impossibility — a grave harm inside a country that cannot be reached, organised, or pressured from within — into a set of specific, answerable, external questions, each attached to a lever the world provides. The harm becomes documentable, from space rather than from the dangerous ground. The exposure becomes a matter of public satellite data rather than of testimony that could endanger anyone. The state companies and buyers become named, external handles on the trade. The lever becomes a concrete, reachable pressure. And the safety question keeps the entire effort outside, where it can be conducted without risking a life. That translation — from an impossible, unreachable harm into a set of specific external actions grounded in the world's ability to see, pledge, and buy — is the first and most important thing a Turkmen effort does, because it moves the fight from the sealed country, where nothing can be done safely, to the world outside, where a great deal can.

## STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on — and here, uniquely, most of it comes not from the ground, which is closed, but from satellites and science, which are open to all. A diplomat, a buyer, a scientist, and a journalist all move on evidence — and in Turkmenistan, a clear, satellite-proven record of the emissions and their source is precisely what an effort turns into a real result, so build it well, and from outside. Build your file in three layers.

### Layer 1: The Harm, the Source, and the Satellite Proof

Get the facts the case turns on — from space and science. Identify the **harm, its source, and its measured scale** — the super-emitting field, the venting flare, the leaking pipeline — and, decisively here, the **satellite and scientific evidence** that measures it, since this is the foundation no state secrecy can erase. The satellite datasets, the scientific studies, and the monitoring bodies that track methane are largely public and reachable. Establish exactly **what is emitted, where, and how it is measured**, because the satellite proof is the fight's unshakeable ground.

### Layer 2: The Scale — Climate, Waste, and Local Harm

Document the scale and the harm. Establish the **climate harm** — the quantity of methane, its outsized near-term warming, its place among the world's worst super-emitter events — and the **economic waste**, since the vented and leaked gas is lost revenue, drawing on **the satellite analyses, the scientific studies, and the international agencies' data**. And, where it can be done safely and from public sources, establish the **local and environmental harm** — the wider damage, the climate risk to the country's own people. Satellite imagery, scientific data, and public reporting make the harm undeniable, and the waste and climate stakes make it a global concern.

### Layer 3: The Harm, the Ties, the Lever, and the Safety

Finally, document the case and the plan. Does the **satellite and scientific evidence** prove the harm? How is it **tied to the state companies and the buyers**? Which **external lever** — the methane diplomacy, the buyers, the economic-waste argument, the diaspora — is open, and what does it require? And, always and above all, **how is the effort kept entirely external and everyone inside kept safe**? Each is a separate



element, and together they make a case that can be pressed through the world that sees the harm, without endangering a soul inside. This is the layer that most often decides these efforts, because a satellite-proven harm, a tie to the trade, an open external lever, and absolute safety are exactly what let an effort reach a sealed state from outside. Build it well, and the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, and the gas buyers become the effort's genuine strength. One practical note on building this layer: the satellite evidence is not merely the most distinctive element of a Turkmen case but the element that makes a case possible at all, and it deserves the fullest attention. In almost every other country, the ground-level evidence — the testimony, the local documentation, the on-site investigation — is the heart of a case, and satellite data merely supplements it. In Turkmenistan, that ground-level evidence cannot be gathered safely, so the ordinary foundation of a case is simply unavailable; and it is precisely the satellite and scientific record that fills the void, supplying from orbit the proof that could never be gathered on the ground. This inversion is the key to the whole approach: because the harm is a methane emission, and because methane can be measured from space, the one kind of evidence that a sealed state cannot suppress is exactly the kind this harm produces. So the file should be built, first and foremost, on the public satellite and scientific record — the datasets, the studies, the monitoring bodies' analyses — because that record is not only the strongest evidence available but very nearly the only evidence that can be gathered at all without endangering anyone.

## WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

Evidence in hand beats evidence you assume exists — and here most of it is gathered from outside, from satellites, science, and public sources, never by endangering anyone inside. Here is where the material tends to live in a Turkmen effort, and how to get it — with the **satellite proof**, the **scale**, the **ties**, and the **external levers** at the center, and safety absolute. Treat this as a checklist to work through, not a menu to admire.

### The Satellite and Scientific Record

Start with the satellite and scientific evidence, which is the foundation and is largely public. **Satellite methane datasets, scientific studies, and the international monitoring bodies' analyses** measure and locate the emissions; these are the distinctive, unshakeable ground of a Turkmen case, and they are open to all, independent of the state's secrecy. Establish the **emissions, their scale, and their source**, drawing on the public satellite and scientific record. Establish exactly **what is emitted, where, and by whom**, because the satellite proof is what a closed state cannot deny.

### The Scale, Climate, and Waste Evidence

This is the heart of the file. Gather the **climate and scale evidence** — the quantity of methane, its outsized near-term warming, its rank among the world's worst super-emitter events — and the **economic-waste evidence**, since the vented and leaked gas is lost money the state might have sold, drawing on **the satellite analyses, the scientific studies, and the international energy and climate agencies' data**. This waste-and-climate evidence is what turns the harm into both a global-climate scandal and a pragmatic argument the state itself can hear.

### The State-Company, Buyer, and Diplomacy Record

Document the ties and the external levers. Gather the record of **which state companies run the sources**; the **buyers and partners** of the gas and their own climate commitments; and the **methane diplomacy** — the pledges, the bodies, the governments urging action, and whether the state has joined or refused them. A

community that can tie a satellite-proven emission to the state companies, to named buyers with their own commitments, and to the world's methane pledges the state has spurned, holds the levers that reach a sealed state.

## The Diaspora and International Record

Document the diaspora and international levers. Identify the **exile media and diaspora organisations** that report on Turkmenistan; the **international climate, energy, and human-rights bodies** engaged; and the **channels** through which the harm can be carried to the world. A community joined to the diaspora and the international bodies holds the voice that a silenced country cannot raise for itself.

## The People, the Safety, and the Effort

Finally — and here first, not last — map the human terrain with absolute care for safety. Who acts — the **diaspora, the international allies, the scientists, the journalists** — since inside the country almost no one can act safely. How is **everyone inside protected absolutely** — never named, never exposed, never asked to take a risk? An effort here is advanced almost entirely from outside, by the diaspora and the world, on behalf of a silenced people — so map that external coalition deliberately, and let the protection of anyone inside govern every step.

## STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Here, more than anywhere, this step must be recast honestly, because inside Turkmenistan there is almost no "local opposition" that can be safely built — organising is nearly impossible and dangerous, and the "community" that acts is, of necessity, largely the diaspora and the international allies who carry the cause on behalf of a silenced people. The task is not to build domestic opposition, which cannot be done safely, but to build an external and diaspora community — informed, connected, and protective of everyone inside — that presses the harm through the world.

## Why the External and Diaspora Community Is Decisive

In Turkmenistan, the community that can act is the one outside, because inside there is no safe space to organise. The external and diaspora community supplies what an effort runs on: the voices, the connection to the country, the legitimacy of speaking for the silenced, and — distinctively — the ability to carry to the world a harm the state hides. When the diaspora and international allies organise to document the harm, press the diplomacy and the buyers, and carry the truth, they become a genuine force. **The external and diaspora community here is not a substitute for a domestic one that cannot exist; it is the necessary and legitimate voice of a silenced people and a harmed world — the real foundation of a Turkmen effort, which must protect absolutely anyone still inside.** This is worth dwelling on, because the shift from a domestic to an external community is not a compromise or a second-best in the Turkmen case but the only honest and safe foundation, and understanding why matters. In an open or even a semi-repressive country, the affected community on the ground is the heart of any effort, and to move the centre of gravity abroad would be to weaken it. In Turkmenistan, the opposite is true: the affected people on the ground genuinely cannot act, cannot speak, and cannot be asked to, without grave danger to themselves and even their families, so an effort that tried to build a domestic community would not only fail but could get people imprisoned or worse. The external and diaspora community is therefore not a pale substitute but the correct and responsible locus of the whole effort — the people who can safely carry the cause, speak the truth, and press the levers, precisely because they are beyond the state's immediate reach. Recognising this clearly, and building the effort deliberately abroad while shielding everyone inside, is not a retreat from the

community but the only form the community can safely take.

## Finding the Community

Begin with those outside who carry the cause — the **diaspora, the exile journalists, the Turkmen abroad, and the international climate and rights allies** — and, always, treat anyone inside as someone to protect, never to expose or recruit into danger. Widen to all who are harmed by the emissions, which — since methane warms the whole planet — is everyone, and to all who care for the silenced people of Turkmenistan. Name the shared stake — **a harm to the whole world's climate, and a voice for a people who cannot speak** — because the methane that leaks over Turkmenistan warms every country, and its people deserve a voice the state denies them. There is an unusual universality to this shared stake, because methane, unlike a local pollutant, warms the entire planet, which means that the harm from Turkmenistan's leaking fields is quite literally shared by every person on earth. This gives the cause a breadth that few environmental struggles possess: it is not only the people of Turkmenistan who are wronged by these emissions but the global climate itself, and therefore everyone who will live with a hotter world. That universality is a strategic strength, because it means the cause can legitimately enlist the concern of the whole international community, every government pledged to cut methane, and every person who cares about the climate — all of whom have a genuine stake in these particular plumes. An effort that names this universal stake, joining the specific injustice done to a silenced people with the general harm done to the world's climate, can summon a global concern that a purely local grievance never could, and can rightly ask the whole world to help press a harm that touches the whole world.

## Coalition-Building, From Outside

A community allied is stronger than a community alone, and in Turkmenistan the coalition is external and global. Reach to the **exile media and diaspora organisations**; the **international climate, energy, and methane bodies**; the **scientists and satellite monitors**; the **human-rights organisations**; and the **sympathetic governments** urging methane action. Frame the coalition around the global climate harm and the voice of a silenced people. Build breadth entirely from outside, and let the protection of anyone inside be the coalition's first rule.

## Sustaining the Effort

Turkmen efforts are sustained through the world's ongoing methane concern and the diaspora's persistence. Keep the external community **informed, connected, and protective**; mark real steps — a satellite report published, a diplomatic approach made, a buyer engaged, an emission cut. And keep the effort grounded in the satellite evidence and the world's climate concern, which are durable and external. The effort that lasts is the one that stays external, safe, and connected to the world's methane diplomacy, carrying the truth the state suppresses until the harm can no longer be ignored. Sustaining such an effort is helped, in the Turkmen case, by the steady and worsening visibility of the harm, which the advancing technology of satellite monitoring makes ever harder to hide. Each year the instruments that watch the earth's methane grow more numerous and more precise, so that the plumes over Turkmenistan's fields, far from fading from view, are documented in ever greater detail by ever more monitors — a mounting, public, scientific record that no amount of state secrecy or extinguished flare stacks can erase. This gives an external effort a rare and durable asset: a body of evidence that grows on its own, independent of anything the state does, and that the diaspora and the international community can return to and build upon indefinitely. The discipline is to stay connected to this advancing scientific record and to the world's steadily deepening concern about methane, so that the effort rides a rising tide of visibility and concern rather than depending on a single moment, and can keep carrying the truth, better documented each year, until the harm can no longer be

ignored.

## STEP 4: LEGAL, REGULATORY & CLIMATE-ACCOUNTABILITY CHALLENGES — THE SATELLITE EVIDENCE, THE METHANE DIPLOMACY, AND THE GAS BUYERS

This is where a Turkmen effort is realistically advanced — not through domestic law or protest, which are closed and dangerous, but through the **satellite evidence, the world's methane diplomacy, and the gas buyers** that reach a sealed state from outside, grounded in the undeniable proof from space. Here the evidentiary, diplomatic, and market levers come together, because in Turkmenistan a harm seen from space and sold to the world is pressed through the world that sees and buys it.

### Setting Expectations Honestly

First, the honest truth. The levers are **real but external, slow, and uneven**. The satellite evidence is **decisive and undeniable**, the one thing the state cannot hide; the methane diplomacy is **real but slow**, and the state has not even joined the world's pledge; the gas buyers are **a lever but an uneven one**, since the main buyer applies little pressure; and domestic law and protest are **effectively closed**. What these levers realistically achieve is **the harm exposed and recorded, diplomatic and economic pressure built, and some emissions cut** — real outcomes, if not a transformation of a sealed state. Enter this front clear-eyed: the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, and the gas buyers are Turkmenistan's distinctive levers, strongest when the **harm is satellite-proven and the external ties are clear** — but inside there is no space, the state depends on gas, and its main buyer cares little.

### The Satellite Evidence

The first and most distinctive front is the satellite evidence. The **methane leaks are measured from space** by scientific and monitoring bodies, and this visibility is the foundation of every other lever, because it makes the harm undeniable regardless of the state's secrecy — the plumes can be seen, located, and attributed. Use the satellite evidence to establish the harm beyond dispute, to name the sources, and to feed every diplomatic, market, and media effort with proof the state cannot deny. In a country that hides everything, the satellite that sees the methane is the community's single greatest asset, and everything else is built on it. It is worth being clear about both the power and the limits of this satellite lever, honestly. Its power is genuinely revolutionary for a case like this: for the first time in history, a specific, quantified environmental harm inside one of the most closed states on earth can be measured, located, and attributed by anyone with access to public satellite data, entirely without the state's cooperation and entirely without endangering anyone on the ground. This is a profound shift, and it is what makes any external effort possible at all. Its limits are also real, and must be acknowledged: the satellite proves the harm but cannot by itself compel a closed, gas-dependent state to fix it; visibility is necessary but not sufficient, and must be married to the diplomatic, economic, and market pressure that can actually move the state. Understanding both means treating the satellite evidence as the indispensable foundation — the thing that makes the harm undeniable and the effort possible — while never mistaking exposure alone for change, and always pairing the proof from space with the external pressures that can turn that proof into action.

### The Methane Diplomacy and the Economic-Waste Argument

The second front is the world's methane diplomacy and the argument the state can hear. The **international methane pledges, bodies, and governments** — the world's collective effort to cut methane — apply a

diplomatic and institutional pressure a closed state still registers, and can be urged to press Turkmenistan to join and act. And the **economic-waste argument** is the distinctive way in: the vented and leaked gas is lost revenue, and cutting the leaks can pay for itself, so even a state indifferent to the climate has a self-interested reason to act — an argument that reaches where climate appeals do not. Pressed together, the world's methane diplomacy and the promise of recovered revenue give a sealed, gas-dependent state both external pressure and a reason of its own.

## The Gas Buyers and the International Bodies

The third front is the trade and the world's bodies. The **buyers and partners of the gas** — the states and companies that purchase or develop it, some with their own climate commitments — can be pressed to demand lower-methane production, a lever on the trade that funds the harm, though an uneven one where the main buyer cares little. And the **international climate, energy, and human-rights bodies** can monitor, scrutinise, and give the cause a voice. Pursued together — the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, the economic-waste argument, the gas buyers, and the international bodies — these fronts are how a Turkmen effort presses a hidden, global harm through the world that can see and reach it, from outside, and while protecting absolutely anyone inside. It is worth understanding why these fronts reinforce one another so well in Turkmenistan's uniquely closed situation. The satellite evidence supplies the undeniable, publicly-verifiable proof that no state secrecy can erase, the ground on which everything else rests. The methane diplomacy supplies the international, governmental pressure that a state, however closed, still registers when it seeks legitimacy, investment, or good relations. The economic-waste argument supplies the one appeal aligned with the state's own self-interest, a reason to act that does not depend on caring about the climate at all. The gas buyers supply pressure from the demand side of the trade that funds the harm. And the international bodies supply the scrutiny and the voice. Each covers the others' limits: the satellites where proof is needed, the diplomacy where governmental pressure helps, the economic argument where self-interest is the only motivator, the buyers where the trade can be leveraged, and the bodies where a global voice matters. An effort that grasps this division of labour, and pursues each front from outside while shielding everyone inside, makes the fullest use of the several external levers that a satellite-visible, globally-traded harm uniquely provides against an otherwise unreachable state.

## TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence does not speak for itself; you must aim it at each decider in the language that moves them. The same satellite-proven file becomes different arguments for the methane diplomats, the gas buyers, the state's own self-interest, and the world. Translate deliberately, and always from outside.

### For the Methane Diplomacy and International Bodies

Diplomats and international bodies respond to **the global climate stakes and the pledges**. Frame the harm as a globally significant methane source that undermines the world's climate goals: here is one of the planet's worst super-emitters, proven from space, outside every pledge. Give them the satellite evidence and urge them to press Turkmenistan to join the methane pledge and act. Make it concrete: *here is the plume, here is the scale, here is the state outside every commitment*. This is the argument that mobilises the world's methane effort.

### For the Gas Buyers and Partners

Buyers and partners respond to **their own climate commitments and reputations**. Frame the harm as the high-methane character of the gas they buy or develop: here is the leaking, venting production behind your

supply or your partnership, against your own commitments. Give them the satellite evidence and ask them to demand lower-methane production. A buyer or partner with its own climate pledge is a lever on the trade, even where the largest buyer is not.

### For the State's Own Self-Interest

The state responds, if at all, to **revenue, not the climate**. Frame the leaks as lost money: here is the gas, worth a fortune, vented into the sky instead of sold, and here is how cheaply it could be captured and sold instead. Give the argument through the diplomatic and technical channels that reach the state. The economic-waste argument is the one appeal a climate-indifferent, gas-dependent state has a self-interested reason to hear.

### For the World and the Silenced People

The world responds to **the drama of a hidden harm exposed and a silenced people**. Translate the file into a story anyone can grasp: one of the world's worst climate polluters, in one of its most closed states, its methane plumes visible from space while its people cannot speak — and a diaspora carrying the truth. Frame it as the harm the world can see but the state won't own. Keep it accurate; credibility is quickly tested. And protect absolutely anyone inside.

### The Golden Rule

Never fabricate, never exaggerate, and never, ever endanger a person inside. Your credibility is your greatest asset before diplomats, buyers, and the world, and the safety of anyone inside a closed and dangerous state is more important than any argument. State the harm precisely from the satellite record, tie it accurately to the trade, and press it entirely from outside. An effort that is precise, credible, and scrupulous about safety — exposing a global harm through the world that can see it — is far harder to dismiss than one that overreaches, and infinitely safer than one that risks a life inside.

## STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Media and attention convert your evidence into pressure — and here, distinctively, the story is a global-climate story that the world can see from space, carried by a diaspora on behalf of a people who cannot tell it themselves. The story — one of the world's worst methane polluters, hidden inside one of its most closed states, its plumes visible from orbit — is one that commands global attention.

### Why Media Matters

The methane diplomats, the gas buyers, and the world behave differently when the harm is visible and undeniable. Media does three things here: it **informs and connects the diaspora and the world**, it **raises the climate and reputational stakes** for the state, its buyers, and its partners, and it **connects the hidden harm to the world's climate conscience** through evidence the state cannot deny. Because the harm is globally significant and satellite-proven, international climate and news media are a genuine, powerful lever here — a super-emitter visible from space, in a sealed state, is a striking global story. But the media effort must be entirely external and scrupulous about safety; no source inside must ever be exposed.

### Crafting Your Narrative

Lead with the satellite-visible harm, the global climate stakes, and the closed state. The strongest frame is concrete and striking: *satellites have revealed one of the world's worst methane polluters inside one of its most closed countries — vast plumes of a climate super-pollutant pouring from state-run fields into the sky*



*the whole world shares, while the state stays outside every pledge and its people cannot speak.* Put the visible, global harm first, and the closure and the waste close behind, because the space-proven harm engages the world and the closure and waste point to the levers. Keep it scrupulously accurate; overstatement is quickly caught. The Turkmen story is powerful because it is a harm the whole world can literally see. This literal visibility is what sets the Turkmen story apart and gives it its force, because it inverts the usual dynamic of a closed state. Ordinarily, the great advantage of a repressive, secretive government is precisely that it can hide what happens within its borders, controlling the information and denying the world any proof of what it does; and ordinarily, that opacity is the campaigner's greatest obstacle. Here, uniquely, the very nature of the harm defeats that opacity: a methane plume rising from a field cannot be concealed by censorship, cannot be denied by a silent ministry, cannot be hidden behind a closed border, because it is written across the sky in a form that orbiting instruments read plainly. A story built on that fact — that the world can see, in hard data, exactly what one of its most secretive states is doing to the shared atmosphere — carries a weight of undeniability that few stories about closed countries ever achieve, and it is that undeniability, more than anything, that gives an external effort its purchase on a state that hides everything else.

## Choosing Your Channels

Match the channel to the audience, all external. The **exile and diaspora media** for the Turkmen abroad and the connection home; the **international climate, energy, and news media** for the world, the diplomats, and the buyers; the **scientific and monitoring platforms** for the evidence; and the **human-rights media** for the silenced people. Because Turkmenistan answers to the world's climate concern and its gas buyers far more than to any domestic voice, the international and diaspora channels are effectively the only ones — and the satellite-visible, global nature of the harm is the story's distinctive power.

## A Few Cautions

Stay accurate, external, and scrupulous about safety — the goal is exposure and pressure, not a story that endangers anyone inside or exaggerates. Frame the story around the satellite-proven global harm and the silenced people, and never expose a source inside. Handle the state and the geopolitics factually and evenhandedly. And sustain the story through the ongoing satellite record and the world's methane concern. Above all, let the striking fact — a global harm the whole world can see from space, in a state that hides everything else — carry the story, because that is where a Turkmen effort is strongest and safest.

## EMAILS & LETTERS: TEMPLATES THAT WORK

Templates save time and prevent mistakes, but adapt every one — insert the real harm, the real satellite evidence, and the real ties, keep it factual, and protect anyone inside absolutely. Here the satellite proof, and safety, win. (These are for external actors; nothing here should be sent by, or expose, anyone inside.)

### 8A: Approach to a Methane or Climate Body

**Subject: A satellite-proven methane super-emitter outside every pledge**

Dear [methane / climate body],

We write regarding [field / source] in Turkmenistan, which satellite data shows to be [one of the world's largest methane super-emitters], a globally significant climate harm from a state that has not joined the world's methane pledge. We respectfully urge you to press for Turkmenistan's engagement and for the reduction of these emissions, and we can provide the satellite and scientific evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

## **8B: Letter to a Gas Buyer or Partner**

**Subject: The high-methane gas behind your [purchase / partnership]**

To [buyer / partner],

Satellite data shows that the gas you [buy from / develop in] Turkmenistan is produced with among the world's highest methane emissions, from leaking and venting sources, contrary to your own climate commitments. We respectfully urge you to demand lower-methane production and leak reduction as a condition of your trade or partnership. We attach the satellite and scientific evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

## **8C: The Economic-Waste Argument (to diplomatic/technical channels)**

**Subject: Recoverable revenue lost to methane leaks in Turkmenistan**

To [relevant body / channel],

The methane vented and leaked from Turkmenistan's gas sector, measured by satellite at [scale], represents a vast quantity of gas lost rather than sold — recoverable, often cheaply, for real revenue. We respectfully offer this evidence to support the case that leak reduction is in the state's own economic interest, and to encourage technical and financial cooperation toward it. We attach the data.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

## **8D: Letter to a Human-Rights or International Body**

**Subject: A hidden environmental harm and a silenced people in Turkmenistan**

To [rights / international body],

We submit information regarding the severe, satellite-proven methane emissions from Turkmenistan's gas sector, and the closed conditions under which its people cannot raise these harms themselves. We respectfully request your scrutiny and voice, and we can provide the satellite and scientific evidence, gathered entirely from public and external sources.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

## **8E: Media Pitch**

**Subject: The methane super-emitter the whole world can see from space**

Dear [journalist],

Satellites have revealed [field / region] in Turkmenistan as one of the world's worst methane super-emitters — vast plumes of a climate super-pollutant from state-run fields, in one of the most closed countries on earth, whose people cannot speak of it. There is a striking global-climate story here, all documented from

public satellite and scientific data, and we can provide the evidence and diaspora voices, with no source inside exposed.

Sincerely,

[Name, organisation, contact]

## **8F: Letter to a Diaspora or Exile Organisation**

**Subject: Carrying the truth of the methane harm together**

Dear [diaspora / exile organisation],

We seek to work with you to document and carry to the world the satellite-proven methane harm from Turkmenistan's gas sector, and to give voice to a people who cannot raise it themselves. Your reach, your knowledge, and your voice are essential, and we can share the satellite and scientific evidence. May we work together — safely, exposing no one inside?

With respect,

[Name, organisation, contact]

## **8G: Submission to a Satellite or Scientific Monitor**

**Subject: Request for monitoring and analysis of [source] in Turkmenistan**

Dear [monitoring / scientific body],

We write regarding apparent methane emissions from [source / region] in Turkmenistan, and respectfully request your monitoring, analysis, or data, to document the scale and source of the harm. This evidence would ground efforts to press for its reduction. We can share what public data we have gathered.

Respectfully,

[Name, organisation, contact]

## **8H: Rallying the External Community**

**Subject: A harm the world can see — let us press it together, safely**

Dear friends,

The satellites have shown what the state would hide: some of the world's worst methane pollution, pouring from Turkmenistan's fields into the sky we all share, while its people cannot speak. From outside, together, we can carry this truth to the world, press the methane diplomacy and the gas buyers, and give voice to the silenced — all without endangering anyone inside. Please join us: share the evidence, connect the allies, and add your voice for a people who cannot raise their own.

With respect,

[Name, organisation]

## **IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION**

Sometimes a harm is acute — a massive super-emitter event underway, a new field or pipeline announced, a diplomatic moment open — and you cannot run the full effort. Triage to the levers that work fastest and

safest here, which means the satellite evidence, the diaspora, and the diplomacy.

## The First 48 Hours

Establish the essentials — all from outside: **what is being emitted, and how the satellites have measured it**. Identify the immediate opening — a **super-emitter event, a new project, a climate summit, a buyer decision** — because that is what you must affect first. Reach the **satellite monitors and the exile media** at once, because in Turkmenistan the space-proven evidence and the diaspora's voice are the fastest routes to real, and safe, leverage — and endanger no one inside.

## The Fastest-Moving Levers

Some levers work faster than others. **The satellite evidence** can be deployed at once, undeniable and public. **The exile and international media** can carry it fast. **A diplomatic moment** — a summit, a pledge deadline — can be seized quickly. **The gas buyers** with their own commitments can be engaged. These outpace the slower work of sustained diplomacy and technical cooperation — which must follow — because the satellite proof and the diaspora's voice can move immediately.

## Emergency Coalition-Building

You cannot build a full coalition overnight, but here you can reach the satellite monitors and exile media fast. Reach immediately to the **satellite and scientific monitors, the exile media, the international climate bodies, and the sympathetic diplomats**. An effort deploying satellite proof, carried by the diaspora, at an open diplomatic moment, is the most a rapid Turkmen effort can do — and the space-proven harm can bite fast. Speed favours the prepared: know the harm, the evidence, and your external allies before the moment opens — and never let urgency endanger anyone inside.

## WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Here, honestly, the system is not merely tilted but effectively closed at home, by one of the most repressive states on earth, dependent on gas, with a main buyer that applies little pressure. This is Turkmenistan's central, honest truth, and the whole guide has been shaped by it. Name it plainly, because pretending there is domestic space, or that the state is easily moved, or that dissent inside is safe, would be not just false but dangerous.

## Recognising a Closed Field

The signs are stark and honest. **There is no domestic space** — no independent press, opposition, or civil society, and dissent is severely punished. **The state depends on gas** — its revenue and power rest on the industry that leaks. **The main buyer cares little** — the largest customer applies scant environmental pressure. **Yet the harm is globally visible** — satellites reveal it, and the world has climate reasons to act. This is not a tilted field but a closed one, and an effort here must be built entirely from outside, on the satellite evidence, the world's methane concern, the buyers, and the diaspora, never on domestic action.

## Strategies for a Closed Field

When the field is closed, use the external levers and the world's ability to see and reach. Lean on the **satellite evidence** that the state cannot hide; the **methane diplomacy** that presses a closed state from outside; the **economic-waste argument** that gives even a gas-dependent state a reason; the **gas buyers** with their own commitments; and the **diaspora** that carries the truth. Rely entirely on the **external and diaspora channels**, and never on domestic organising, which is impossible and unsafe. Build the record

and the pressure over time, because a satellite-proven harm, carried to the world and pressed through its diplomacy and trade, accumulates into real leverage even on a sealed state. A closed field is worked from outside, through the world that can see and buy, never through a domestic space that does not exist.

## The Honest Possibility of Losing

You may achieve little visible change — the state may keep leaking, stay outside the pledges, ignore the pressure — and this guide will not pretend otherwise; the state is closed, gas-dependent, and hard to move. But here the work is rarely wholly wasted: the **harm was exposed and recorded from space, the world's methane diplomacy was engaged, the buyers were pressed, and the truth was carried by the diaspora** — and every plume documented, every pledge urged, every buyer moved builds a pressure that a satellite-proven, globally significant harm cannot forever escape. Press for change; even if the state resists, the undeniable record you built, the diplomacy you engaged, and the truth you carried will press it over time, because a harm the whole world can see, once exposed and pursued, is one the world does not easily forget.

## WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — AND WHO IS CAPTURED

In Turkmenistan, the capture of the state and its gas wealth is near-total and notorious — the country is among the world's most corrupt, its vast gas revenues opaque and concentrated at the top, its state companies unaccountable, its people denied even the free gas they once received. This must be approached from outside and with the utmost care, because inside the country exposing corruption is extraordinarily dangerous, and the only safe route runs through the international bodies, the satellite and financial transparency organisations, and the diaspora.

## Telling Capture from the Ordinary Tilt

In most states there is a line between an ordinary tilt and capture; in Turkmenistan the capture is the system — the gas wealth flows to a tiny elite while the sector leaks and the people go without. The marks are stark: **opaque, unaccountable state gas companies, vast revenues concentrated at the top, no transparency and no accountability, and a people denied the benefits of their own resource**. Be rigorous and careful, and rely on external evidence: the **satellite proof of the waste**, the **international transparency and financial-integrity organisations**, and the **diaspora's documentation** are the safe tools, because inside the country there is no safe way to pursue this at all, and the risk to any person inside is severe.

## Responding to Capture — From Outside, Carefully

Where capture is the system, the response runs entirely through the external and international channels. Use the **international transparency, anti-corruption, and financial-integrity organisations** that can pursue opaque gas wealth from beyond the state's reach. Use the **satellite evidence of waste** to show the gap between the gas leaked and the people's want. Use the **diaspora** to document and carry the truth. Protect every source absolutely, because inside a state this closed, the exposure of corruption can cost a life. Route everything through the international bodies and the diaspora — never through any domestic action, which is impossible and deadly.

## A Note on Safety and Care

This is the guide's most important note by far, and it governs everything. Turkmenistan is among the most repressive states on earth, where criticism of the state can bring imprisonment, disappearance, or worse,

and where even families of exiles abroad may face reprisal. So this work must be done **entirely from outside**, and the protection of any person inside — and of exiles' families — must come before every other consideration. Never name, expose, or contact a source inside in any way that could endanger them; rely on public satellite and scientific data and on the diaspora and international bodies; and take the lead of experienced exile organisations who understand the risks. Safety here is not one concern among others; it is the absolute precondition of the entire effort, because no exposure, no pressure, and no cause is worth a single life, and because the real work — pressing a global harm through the world that can see it — can and must be done without endangering anyone inside.

## INTEGRATION & TIMELINE: RUNNING ALL FIVE STEPS TOGETHER

The steps in this guide are written in sequence but run in parallel, each feeding the others — all from outside. Here is how they fit into a single, careful, external effort.

### The Parallel Effort

From the start, the five run together, externally and safely. **Documentation** builds the satellite-and-science file. **Target identification** aims it at the external levers. **Local opposition**, recast, builds the external and diaspora community. **Legal, regulatory, and climate-accountability** work presses the satellite evidence, the methane diplomacy, and the buyers. **Media** carries it to the world. The satellite-proven harm feeds all five at once — a documented plume is a diplomatic case, a buyer argument, an economic-waste point, and a global story together. Run in parallel, they compound; run one at a time, they stall — and here, spanning a sealed state and the whole world's climate, they compound into a global cause the state cannot forever hide from.

### A Rough Timeline

**Early (weeks 1–8):** establish the harm and its satellite proof; identify the sources, the buyers, the methane bodies, and the diaspora allies; begin documentation from public data. **Middle (months 2–18):** press the methane diplomacy and the economic-waste argument; engage the buyers and partners; carry the truth through the diaspora and international media; and urge the pledges. **Later (months and years):** build the exposure and pressure, seek emission cuts and engagement, and keep the record whatever the state's resistance. A Turkmen effort is patient and external, and its fruits — exposure and slow pressure — are long in coming; pace it accordingly, and let safety govern every step.

### The Core Discipline

Through it all, hold the discipline that gives these efforts their force: **document the harm from satellites and science; press the methane diplomacy, the buyers, and the economic-waste argument; carry it through the diaspora and the world; and protect absolutely anyone inside.** The effort that presses all five, spanning a sealed state and the world's climate, and endangering no one inside, is the one that can genuinely expose this hidden harm and build real pressure — the kind of result that one of the world's most closed states allows.

## FINAL ASSESSMENT

Opposing a destructive harm in Turkmenistan is genuinely difficult — harder, in one sense, than anywhere, because inside the country there is almost no space to act and dissent is dangerous — and this guide has



been honest about that from its first line: there is no landmark victory, the state has not even joined the world's methane pledge, and the work must be done from outside. And yet the effort is far from futile, because Turkmenistan's methane harm is a globally significant one that satellites reveal regardless of the state's secrecy, the gas has buyers and partners who can be pressed, the world has pledged and has reason to act, and a diaspora carries the truth — and those satellite, diplomatic, market, and diaspora levers are real.

Some honest truths hold across every effort here. **The satellite evidence is decisive — a closed state cannot hide a methane plume from space, and that visibility is the whole foundation. The diaspora and the world's methane diplomacy carry and press the harm from outside. The economic-waste argument is the way in — leaked gas is lost money even a climate-indifferent state can hear. But inside there is almost no space, the state depends on gas, its buyer cares little, and dissent is dangerous.** Hold both truths at once: real, external, world-spanning levers, and the honest weight of one of the most closed states on earth.

Above all, keep the discipline — and the absolute care for safety — that give these efforts their force. Document the harm from satellites and science. Press the methane diplomacy, the buyers, and the economic-waste argument. Carry it through the diaspora and the world. And protect absolutely anyone inside — because in a state this closed and dangerous, an effort that presses a global harm through the world that can see it, while endangering no one inside, is the one that is both effective and just.

Turkmenistan sits on some of the world's greatest reserves of gas, and from its leaking fields and venting flare stacks pours one of the planet's largest streams of methane — a climate super-pollutant warming the sky the whole world shares — while inside its borders one of the most closed and repressive states on earth allows no press, no opposition, no voice, and denies even the truth of what its own satellites-visible fields emit; this guide has hidden none of it, nor pretended that a people so silenced can safely organise, or that a state so sealed is easily moved, and there is no landmark community victory here to promise you — not even the world's basic pledge to cut methane, which this state has spurned. But the harm is one the whole world can see from space, and that is the key: the satellites that cannot be blinded, the world's methane diplomacy, the buyers of the gas, the argument that the leaks are lost money, and the diaspora that carries the truth are all real levers that reach a sealed state from outside. There is no easy victory, and no landmark precedent to inherit; this guide has said so throughout, and insisted, above all, that no person inside be endangered. But the air of the whole world, and the voice of a silenced people, are worth defending, the external levers that reach even the most closed of states are real, and the patient, careful work of documenting the harm from space, pressing the world's methane diplomacy and the buyers, and carrying the truth through the diaspora is one that can genuinely be done — from outside, and safely, on behalf of a people who cannot yet do it themselves. So can you.